

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 849

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Elijah Spence of Gatlinburg-Pittman High School upon being named All-County in football.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize and commend those successful high school athletes who, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors of this State; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable individual is Elijah Spence of Gatlinburg-Pittman High School in Sevier County, an athlete of extraordinary talent, skill, and dedication, who has proven himself a formidable competitor on the football field; and

WHEREAS, Elijah Spence was recently named to the All-County team in recognition of his excellence on the gridiron for Gatlinburg-Pittman High School; and

WHEREAS, a senior three-way player, Mr. Spence was also named to the Tennessee Sports Writers Association All-State and Tennessee Football Coaches Association All-State teams and the All-Region 1-3A first team; and

WHEREAS, as a wide receiver, he recorded 57 receptions for 1,036 yards and 14 touchdowns and averaged 18.2 yards per reception for the 2025 season; and

WHEREAS, on defense, Elijah Spence recorded 53 tackles, 10 passes broken up, and 5 interceptions; and

WHEREAS, on special teams, Mr. Spence returned one kickoff for a touchdown and had 7 punt returns for 189 yards; and

WHEREAS, Elijah Spence epitomizes all that is good in today's student athlete, as he has achieved a high level of success in sports while evincing great character both on and off the field; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Spence's notable achievement is a source of great pride for his family, his community, and his school, and it is appropriate that we recognize this accomplished athlete; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Elijah Spence of Gatlinburg-Pittman High School on being named to the All-County football team, wishing him much success and happiness in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.